CHAPTER V

CONTROL AND WORKING OF STATIONS

5.01 RESPONSIBILITY OF THE STATION MASTER FOR WORKING.—

(1) The Station Master shall be responsible for the efficient discharge of the duties devolving upon the staff employed, either permanently or temporarily, under his orders at the station or within the station limits and such staff shall be subject to his authority and direction in the working of the station.

(2) The Station Master shall see that all signals, points, gates of level crossings and the whole machinery of his station are in proper working order and shall immediately report all defects therein to the proper authority.

(3) The Station Master shall also be responsible to see that the working of the station is carried out in strict accordance with the rules and regulations for the time being in force.

(4) No person other than the Station Master shall ask for or give Line Clear, or give authority to proceed.

5.02 SUPPLY OF COPIES OF RULES AND DISTRIBUTION OR EXHIBITION OF OTHER DOCUMENTS.—The Station Master shall see—

(a) that every railway servant subordinate to him who should be supplied with a copy of authorised translation of these rules under Rule 2.01 duly receives the same;

(b) that the Working Time Table in force together with all correction slips and appendices, if any, working rules and instructions, and other notices having reference to the working of the line, are properly distributed or exhibited in such manner as may be prescribed under special instructions;

(c) that both the sheet time tables and fare lists are correctly exhibited at the station if it is open for the booking of traffic; and

(d) that copies of the Act, and the Goods and Coaching Tariffs are available for inspection by the public.

5.03 OBEDIENCE TO ORDERS AND KEEPING OF BOOKS AND RETURNS.—The Station Master shall see that all orders and instructions are duly conveyed to the staff concerned and are properly carried out, and that all books and returns are regularly written up and neatly kept.

5.04 SIGNAL CABINS.—

(1) The Station Master shall make himself thoroughly acquainted with the duties of the staff employed in the signal cabins, if any, at his station and shall satisfy himself that they perform their duties correctly, and in order to maintain an effective supervision over the said staff, frequently visit the signal cabins.

(2) The Station Master shall ensure that the prescribed equipment is readily available in signal cabins and maintained in good working order.

(3) Signal cabins shall be kept neat and clean and no unauthorised person shall be permitted to enter such cabins.

5.05 REPORT OF NEGLECT OF DUTY.—The Station Master shall report, without delay, to his superior, all neglect of duty on the part of any railway servant who is under his orders.

5.06 STATION WORKING RULES.—

(1) In addition to the General Rules for Indian Railways and Subsidiary Rules of a Railway, each station shall be provided with Station Working Rules applicable to the station, issued under special instructions.

(2) A copy of the Station Working Rules or relevant extracts thereof shall be kept at cabins and level crossings concerned.

5.07 FORMS.—

(1) All messages and written authorities mentioned in these rules shall be prepared on prescribed forms laid down in these rules or prescribed under special instructions and shall be stamped with the station stamp.

(2) If the authorised printed forms is not available for any reason or in exceptional circumstances, a manuscript form containing all the particulars as contained in the prescribed form is issued as an emergency measure, reasons there for shall be recorded in the station diary.

5.08 ACCESS AND OPERATION OF EQUIPMENT.—No unauthorised person shall be permitted to have access to or operate signals, points, electrical block instruments and electrical communication instruments or any other appliances connected with working of the railway.

5.09 RECEPTION OF A TRAIN ON AN OBSTRUCTED LINE.—

(1) In case of reception of a train on an obstructed line, the Station Master shall—

(a) Whenever possible, intimate the Loco Pilot through the Station Master of the station in rear that the train is to be received on an obstructed line;

(b) ensure that the signal or signals controlling the reception of the train are not taken 'off'; and

(c) ensure that all the points over which the train has to pass are correctly set and the facing points locked.

(2) After the train has been brought to a stand at the relevant Stop signal, it may be received on the obstructed line by—

(a) authorising the Loco Pilot to pass the Stop signal at 'on' by taking 'off' the Calling-on signal, where provided; or

(b) authorising the Loco Pilot on the signal post telephone, where provided, to pass the Stop signal at 'on', in accordance with special instructions; or

(c) authorising the Loco Pilot to pass the relevant signal or signals at 'on' through a written authority to be delivered by a competent railway servant who shall pilot the train past such signal or signals.

(3) The train shall be brought to a stand at the facing points leading to the reception line until hand-signalled forward by a competent railway servant.

(4) A Stop hand signal shall be exhibited at a distance of not less than 45 metres from the point of obstruction to indicate to the Loco Pilot as to where the train shall be brought to a stand.

(5) The Loco Pilot shall keep his train well under his control and be prepared to stop short of any obstruction.

5.10 RECEPTION OF A TRAIN ON A NON-SIGNALLED LINE.—

(1) Should it be necessary, in an emergency, to receive a train on a line which is not signalled for reception, the Station Master shall ensure that—

(a) the train is brought to a stand at the first Stop signal;

(b) the line on which it is intended to receive the train is clear up to the trailing points or upto the place at which the train is required to come to a stand;

(c) all the points over which the train has to pass are correctly set and the facing points locked; and

(d) the Loco Pilot is authorised to pass the approach Stop signal at 'on' through a written authority to be delivered by a competent railway servant who shall pilot the train on to the non-signalled line.

(2) The Loco Pilot, while entering a non-signalled line, shall proceed cautiously and be prepared to stop short of any obstruction.

5.11 DEPARTURE OF A TRAIN FROM A NON-SIGNALLED LINE.—

(1) In the event of a train required to be started from a line not provided with a Starter signal, the Loco Pilot shall be given a written permission to start:

Provided that such permission may be dispensed with where a tangible authority to proceed is given to the Loco Pilot.

(2) The written permission or the tangible authority to proceed referred to in sub-rule(1) shall not be given unless all the points for the departure of the train have been set and the facing points locked.

5.12 DEPARTURE OF A TRAIN FROM A LINE PROVIDED WITH A COMMON DEPARTURE SIGNAL.—

(1) In the event of a train required to be started from a line out of a group of lines provided with a common departure signal, the Loco Pilot shall be given a written permission to start in addition to the authority to proceed under the system of working.

(2) The written permission and the authority to proceed referred to in sub-rule (1) shall not be given unless all the points for the departure of the train have been set and the facing points locked.

5.13 CONTROL OF SHUNTING.—

(1) Shunting operations shall be controlled by fixed signals or hand signals or by verbal directions.

(2) The Loco Pilot shall not, however, depend entirely on signals and shall always be vigilant and cautious.

(3) The speed during shunting operations shall not exceed 15 kilometres an hour unless otherwise authorised by special instructions.

5.14 RESPONSIBILITY FOR SHUNTING.—The Station Master shall see that the shunting of trains or vehicles is carried on only at such times and in such manner as will not involve danger.

5.15 SHUNTING AT STATIONS UNDER CENTRALISED TRAFFIC CONTROL.—

(1) No shunting shall be performed at a station under Centralised Traffic Control without the permission of the Centralised Traffic Control Operator or when Centralised Traffic Control is not in operation, without the permission of the Station Master.

(2) For the purpose of shunting, the Centralised Traffic Control Operator may, when required, hand over the local control of working of traffic at a station or part of a station to the Station

Master who shall thereafter be responsible for the shunting at the station or that part of the station for which the local control has been made over to him in the manner prescribed under special instructions.

5.16 SHUNTING DURING RECEPTION OF TRAINS.—When signals have been taken 'off' for an incoming train on to a line which is not isolated, no shunting movement shall be carried out towards points over which the incoming train is to pass.

5.17 SHUNTING NEAR LEVEL CROSSING.—The railway servant in charge of shunting near or across a level crossing, before giving permission to the Loco Pilot to move his train across it, shall ensure that the level crossing gates have been closed and locked against road traffic.

5.18 DRAWING OF A TRAIN TO AN ADVANCED POSITION.—

(1) A train waiting for an authority to proceed shall not be allowed to draw out upto an Advanced Starter for despatch, except where track circuit or Axle Counter has been provided between the Starter and Advanced Starter to indicate the presence of a train in advanced position.

(2) The provision of sub-rule (1) shall not apply in case of shunting of a train within a station section itself.

5.19 OBSTRUCTION OF RUNNING LINE.—

(1) No railway servant shall commence any loading, shunting or any other operation by which a running line, may be fouled or obstructed without obtaining the previous sanction of the Station Master or of other railway servant nominated in this behalf under special instructions, who shall see that all necessary steps are taken for the protection of traffic while such operation is being carried on and the necessary signals are kept at 'on' until the obstruction is removed.

(2) A sand hump or snag dead end shall not be obstructed for any purpose and when it has become obstructed, it shall cease to be a substitute for the adequate distance for the purpose of taking 'off' signals.

5.20 SHUNTING ON GRADIENTS.—When shunting is being performed on a gradient, the railway servant in charge of the shunting shall ensure that—

(a) sufficient number of brakes are put on, sprags are used, where necessary, slip siding points or traps, where provided, are set to ensure safety and that all precautions are taken to prevent vehicles getting out of control, and

(b) in case of shunting over a portion of line on steep gradients, neither isolated nor protected by slip sidings, an engine is also attached towards the falling side of the gradient.

Note.— For purposes of this rule a steep gradient shall be 1 in 260 or steeper except in case of vehicles fitted with roller bearings when it shall be 1 in 400 or steeper.

5.21 LOOSE SHUNTING.—Cranes, vehicles containing passengers, workers, explosives, dangerous goods or live-stock or any other vehicle that may be specified under special instructions, shall not be loose shunted and no loose shunting shall be made against them.

5.22 LEAVING VEHICLES IN SIDINGS OUTSIDE STATION LIMITS.—No railway servant shall leave any vehicle in a siding outside station limits, unless the vehicle is clear of all running lines and, except under special instructions, unless the wheels thereof are properly secured.

5.23 SECURING OF VEHICLES AT STATION.—The Station Master shall see that vehicles standing at the station are properly secured in accordance with special instructions.

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